

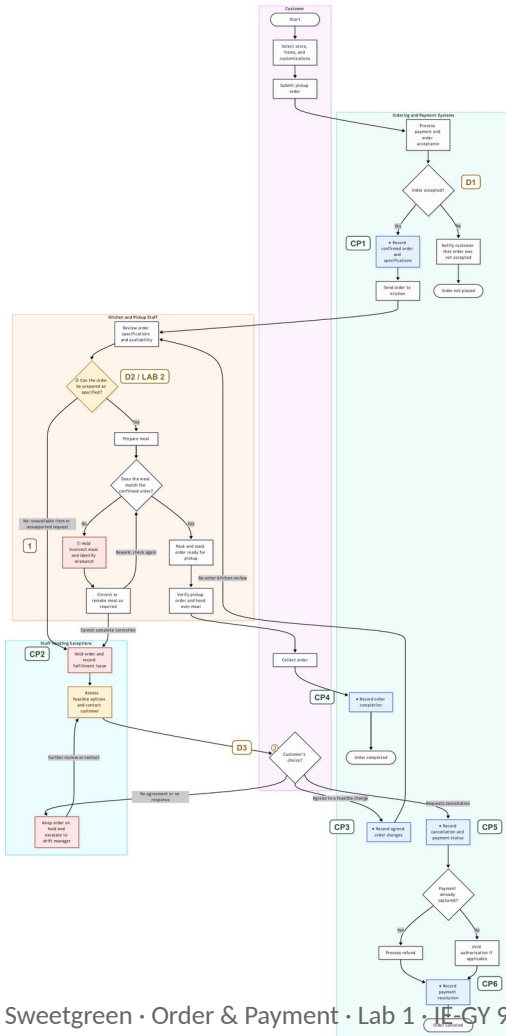
Sweetgreen: Order & Payment

Lab 1 — Diagnose & Map a Process

Map · three diagnostic points · curveball · synthetic data · board-level consequence

The process map

Digital ordering hands off to kitchen execution at $G \rightarrow H \rightarrow I$ — exactly where this map's rejection/rework path lives.



Worst friction

Hold → correct/remake → recheck loop when the meal doesn't match the confirmed order.

Stable rules → Lab 2

Can the order be prepared as specified? Automate first — but the input needs a freshness gate (see curveball).

Judgment → Lab 3

Staff assess feasible options and the customer consents. No clean rule for which compromise to offer.

Nightly batch, not real time

Deck card #3. Availability data feeding decision ② now comes from two places — a live system, and a nightly legacy cache — and they don't always agree.

BEFORE

② **Can the order be prepared as specified?**

One clean yes/no rule against a single availability check. Easy to automate — nothing left to design.

AFTER — CURVEBALL ABSORBED

STALE: do live and cached availability agree?

A precondition sits in front of ②. When the nightly cache disagrees with the live system, the order holds for a reason distinct from “unavailable item” — a freshness gate, not a menu fix.

24 menu configurations seeded **10** live/cache mismatches

Board-level consequence

\$44

in modeled exposure

60 labor minutes × \$0.40/min + \$20 refunds = \$44, or \$7.33 per affected order.

6 / 30

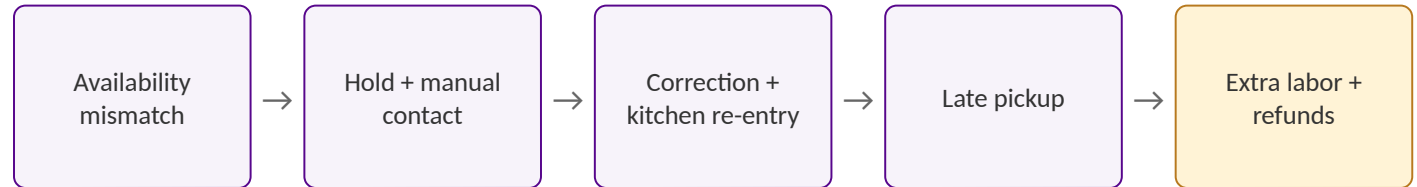
synthetic orders reworked

20%

rework rate

18.7 min

average lateness



Synthetic, illustrative sample — not measured Sweetgreen performance. No company-wide extrapolation from 30 orders at one modeled store.

Two targets, one milestone

LAB 2 — MAKE (NEXT WEEK: RPA)

D2: the freshness gate

Automate “can the order be prepared as specified” — but the automation has to resolve live-vs-cached disagreement, not just the yes/no rule.

LAB 3 — RELEVANCE AI

D3: the recovery decision

Staff assess feasible options and the customer consents. An agent can support that judgment; it can't make the customer's choice.

Fewer missed pickup promises, less avoidable recovery work. \$44 is modeled exposure, not a guaranteed saving.